MEMORANDUM

TO: **Bret Pehrson**
IT Software Developer IV
UIT Univ Support Services

FROM**:** **Reza Sarijlou**
Mgr, Software Dev. Engrg
UIT Univ Support Services

Reza Sarijlou
Signature

DATE: **June 1, 2026**

SUBJECT: **Notification of Pre-Disciplinary Conference**

I am writing to inform you of my intent to consider the termination of your employment pursuant to University *Rule* 5-111A**.** Specifically, it has been determined that your conduct as more fully described below violates university *Rule 5-111C-Egregious Behavior.*

There have been three recent reports alleging you engaged in inappropriate behavior while at work and in the presence of coworkers. We have previously discussed that such behavior is not acceptable and that you are expected to behave professionally at all times.

During a prior discussion in 2024 regarding your accidental transmission of adult content to a coworker via iMessage, workplace professionalism and appropriate workplace conduct expectations were discussed. At that time, no formal corrective action was taken. It was discussed however, that employees within the department are expected to maintain professional workplace conduct consistent with University and departmental standards at all times while on University property and while interacting with coworkers.

I met with you on April 27, 2026, to discuss concerns that had been reported regarding you engaging in inappropriate workplace conduct. During that meeting, I shared with you that it was reported on April 22, 2026, you asked a coworker to come to your cubicle near the end of the workday when few employees remained in the office. The coworker reported that when they arrived at your cubicle, you had lowered your pants to your ankles. When asked about this incident during our meeting, you acknowledged that the incident occurred and stated that it was intended as a joke, though you also acknowledged that it was inappropriate and a lapse in judgment.

As a result of your behavior on April 22, 2026 an additional concern was brought forward. It was reported that roughly a year ago during an interaction in a workplace restroom, you exposed yourself to the same coworker while discussing and demonstrating an adult device. During this April 27,2026, meeting, you acknowledged that this interaction occurred, though you stated it was not intended to be sexual in nature. You further stated that you “effed up” and that you “trusted the wrong person.”

Further concerns were later reported on May 14, 2026, alleging that you admitted to a coworker that you had been engaging in the act of masturbation within the workplace when other employees were not present.

The reported and admitted conduct described above is unacceptable and will not be tolerated; it is inconsistent with expectations of professional conduct within the University of Utah workplace environment.

The University of Utah fosters student success by preparing students for lives of impact as leaders and citizens. We generate and share new knowledge, discoveries, and innovations, and we engage local and global communities to promote education, individual and community health, and quality of life. This is achieved through excellence in patient care, education, and research; each is vital to our mission and each makes the others stronger. These contributions, in addition to responsible stewardship of our intellectual, physical, and financial resources, ensure the long-term success and viability of the institution. Your behavior in this instance has not demonstrated a productive contribution to the mission of the University or of the UIT Univ Support Services.

This memorandum also provides you notice that based on the outcome of the Pre-Disciplinary Conference the University may designate you as not eligible to reapply for employment at the University of Utah for at least five (5) years. This designation will also make you not eligible for participation in volunteer services at the University of Utah for a minimum of five (5) years. If it is determined you are not eligible to reapply for employment, you will receive written notification of that designation and of your options for objecting to that designation. Should you choose to resign from your position, you will forfeit your right to appeal an involuntary termination and you may still be designated not eligible to reapply, though you could choose to object this designation.

University of Utah Human Resource Management has reviewed the specific concerns outlined in this document. I have been advised to schedule a Pre-Disciplinary Conference on your behalf for the purpose of allowing you an opportunity to respond to these concerns. The Pre-Disciplinary Conference will occur via Zoom on **Tuesday**, **June 2, 2026**, at **10:15am**. Please join us via Zoom at the scheduled time; the meeting is schedule for one hour.
Laura Walkinshaw is inviting you to a scheduled Zoom meeting.
Join Zoom Meeting
https://utah.zoom.us/j/88461236683

Meeting ID: 884 6123 6683
Passcode: UHRM2026

One tap mobile
+17193594580,,88461236683#,,,,*96191473# US
+12532050468,,88461236683#,,,,*96191473# US

Join by SIP
• 88461236683@zoomcrc.com
Passcode: 96191473

Join instructions
https://utah.zoom.us/meetings/88461236683/invitations?signature=Zan4yPU1XTwNkRFsvT2wJoSGgP7uxyW_dzmk_rWPU6I

Laura Walkinshaw, Human Resources Specialist, will be in attendance in an advisory capacity in order to facilitate the Pre-Disciplinary process. If you would prefer to respond to these concerns in writing, rather than participating in a Zoom call, please submit your written statement to me by **Tuesday**, **June 2, 2026**, at **10:15am**. I am providing you with a Frequently Asked Questions sheet regarding this process and encourage you to read it carefully.

As noted above, the purpose of the Pre-Disciplinary Conference is to provide you a "right-of-response." Please review the details of my concerns outlined in this Notification of Pre-Disciplinary Conference as well as the enclosed documentation, if any, prior to the meeting so that you are aware of the reasons upon which the recommendation for disciplinary action are based.

If you fail to attend the Pre-Disciplinary Conference as scheduled, I will assume that you are voluntarily forfeiting your right of response.

Your paid administrative leave effective May 20, 2026 remains in place. I anticipate that you will remain on administrative leave until a determination has been made in consideration of your Pre-Disciplinary Conference; however, the leave may be extended if necessary. For the duration of this administrative leave, you affirm and agree to refrain from the following until you are notified by me:

- Visiting the University campus or your work unit except for the following:
  (i) to obtain an assessment from the Employee Assistance Program as specified below,
  (ii) as required for your own personal health care needs; and
  (iii) as required to comply with any investigation or inquiry undertaken by the University;
- Contacting University students, staff, faculty, or other individuals; and
- Conducting University business, remotely or otherwise.

Please ensure contact information for you is correct so we may reach you during the administrative leave if necessary. **Personal Phone:** 801-921-8125 **Personal Email:** bretutah@gmail.com

Please contact Karen Iannucci, Human Resources Associate Director, at 801-587-9771 if you have questions regarding the Pre-Disciplinary process.

The University offers an Employee Assistance Program. For more information on what is available to you, please visit https://benefits.utah.edu/employee-assistance-program-and-mental-health/ or contact the program for a confidential consultation at 801-587-9319. State and federal labor law notifications can be found at https://www.hr.utah.edu/serviceTeams/employee-notices.php and/or in University Human Resources offices.

cc: HR Associate Director – Karen Iannucci
Department of Employee Relations
Employee File